RealWorld QA Assessment Report

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APPLICATION	BUILD	COVERAGE	RESULT
RealWorld / Conduit	**demo.realworld.show**	**Auth ✦ Article CRUD**	**7 issues logged**

Test summary

Objective. Exercise registration, login, article creation, editing, deletion, and logout; identify functional, usability, and accessibility defects.

Environment. RealWorld Angular demo at https://demo.realworld.show/ in the Codex in-app Chromium browser; desktop viewport; test session executed 8 November 2026 (IST).

Test data. Disposable user soumyadeep_oytra_20 261 108 and temporary article “Soumyadeep Oytra QA Automation Test”. The article was created, edited, and deleted successfully.

Functional coverage

Scenario	Outcome	Evidence
Register and authenticate	PASS	Account created; logout and login-again verified
Create article	PASS	Title, description, body, and tag persisted
Edit article	PASS	Updated description and body displayed
Delete article	PASS	Returned to global feed; article route removed from session

Defect log

ID	Title / summary	Severity	Steps to reproduce	Expected vs actual	Suspected cause
RW-001	Weak passwords accepted	**High**	Open Sign up; enter a unique username and valid email; enter a one-character password; submit.	Expected: reject weak passwords and state the minimum policy. Actual: submission succeeds with a one-character password.	Password policy is absent or not enforced consistently in the client and API.
RW-002	Inputs lack persistent labels and field metadata	**Medium**	Inspect Sign up and Sign in; type values so placeholders disappear; inspect required, autocomplete, and minlength attributes.	Expected: visible labels and appropriate browser metadata. Actual: fields rely on placeholders and omit useful constraints.	A shared form-field component was built around visual placeholders without a semantic contract.
RW-003	Avatar links have no accessible name	**High**	Open Global Feed; navigate article metadata links with a screen reader or accessibility tree.	Expected: each profile link exposes the author name. Actual: avatar profile links are announced as empty links.	Avatar images lack descriptive alternatives and their wrapping links have no fallback label.
RW-004	Favorite controls expose icon glyphs	**High**	Open Global Feed; inspect or focus an article favorite button.	Expected: a name such as 'Favorite article, 1 favorite.' Actual: an unreadable private-use glyph is announced before the count '1'.	The button derives its accessible name from an icon-font character instead of an explicit label.
RW-005	Article cards misuse level-one headings	**Medium**	Open Global Feed; inspect the heading outline.	Expected: one page h1 followed by logical h2 or h3 article headings. Actual: the page title and every article title are h1 elements.	The reusable article-card component hard-codes h1 without considering page-level document structure.
RW-006	Invalid login error is generic and unassociated	**Medium**	Enter a valid-looking email and an incorrect one-character password; submit.	Expected: actionable, field-associated feedback that avoids account enumeration. Actual: only 'credentials invalid' appears.	The API error is rendered as a generic form message without mapping it to accessible field guidance.
RW-007	Settings route temporarily renders stale feed	**Low**	While authenticated, select Settings and observe content before the route completes.	Expected: a loading state or the prior route until Settings is ready. Actual: /settings briefly displays the global feed.	Route activation and view replacement occur before the settings component finishes loading.

Root-cause analysis

RW-004 occurs because the favorite button exposes its icon-font character and count as the control's accessible name. A sighted user recognizes the heart-shaped glyph, but a screen reader receives the private-use character because the component has no explicit label. Icon fonts do not provide stable semantics, so the announced value can vary by font loading and assistive technology. The reusable feed-card component appears to treat the icon as sufficient button content rather than separating visual presentation from the control name. I would mark the icon as decorative and add an aria-label that describes the action, article context, and current favorite state. The label should update after the user favorites or unfavorites an article, while the visible count remains separate text. Component tests should assert the accessible name in both states, and an automated axe check should cover the global feed to prevent recurrence.

Risk and recommendations

- Prioritize RW-001, RW-003, and RW-004 because they affect account security expectations and keyboard/screen-reader access to core actions.
- Define password rules once and enforce them consistently in UI and API, while keeping authentication errors account-enumeration safe.
- Add automated accessibility checks (axe-core) to registration, login, feed, editor, article, and settings routes.
- Add component-level tests for accessible names, labels, heading hierarchy, and loading states; include keyboard-only smoke coverage in CI.

Exit statement

All required authenticated flows completed successfully. The seven issues above are reproducible in the tested build; no destructive data remains because the temporary article was deleted after verification.